



Country Intelligence Brief

Italy

Overall Risk Rating

2.00 - Low

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Ratings Overview

Security

2.00 - Low

Civil Unrest
Crime
Kidnapping
Terrorism
Armed Conflict
Security Services

2.50
2.50
2.00
2.00
1.00
2.00

Infrastructure

2.50 - Moderate

Ground Transport
Cyber
Maritime Services
Air Travel
Utilities

2.75
3.00
1.50
2.00
2.00

Environment

2.00 - Low

Man-Made Hazards
Seismic
Storm System
Natural Hazards

1.75
3.00
2.00
2.00

Health and Medical

2.25 - Low

Disease and Health Threats
Medical Facilities and Services
Mental Health
Food and Water Safety

2.00
2.50
3.00
2.00

Political

2.25 - Low

Corruption
Government Stability
Rule of Law
Sanctions

2.75
2.25
2.00
2.00

LGBTQ Security

2.00 - Low

LGBTQ Legal Environment
LGBTQ Enforcement
LGBTQ Social Environment

3.00
2.00
3.00

FactBox

Location	Italy
Government Type	Parliamentary Republic
Population	58,930,000 (2025)
Languages	Official Language: Italian Other languages that are considered official or widely spoken: English; French (Valle d'Aosta); German (Trentino-Alto Adige); Slovene (Trieste-Gorizia) Languages that should be used discreetly: None
International Country Code	+39
Time Zones	UTC+1
Traffic	Drives on the right
Drinking Water	Safe to Drink

Overview

2.00 - Low

The Italian Republic is located in Southern Europe. It includes the two largest islands of the Mediterranean Sea, Sicily and Sardinia. Italy is a stable democracy and is generally safe for work and travel, although demonstrations are frequently held in response to social frustrations and can occasionally escalate into localized violence. Labor strikes often take place and are usually well publicized ahead of time. The Italian economy is the fourth largest in Europe and considered to be strong, although the country suffers from rising public debt and unemployment. Additionally, southern Italy remains economically weaker than the prosperous north. Islamist terrorism is a concern, and authorities have broken up several recruitment cells. Violent crime is not very common, but petty crime, such as pickpocketing or bag-snatching is frequently reported, especially in cities. Businesses should note that organized criminal networks have a huge presence in the economy, especially in the southern regions such as Sicily, although their activities are unlikely to impact tourists and travelers.

Italy is a member of NATO, the EU and the Schengen area.

Security

2.00 - Low

The biggest threat to foreign travelers is from petty and opportunistic theft, particularly in major cities such as Naples and Rome. Scams are commonplace, and foreigners or tourists are often specifically targeted. There is growing concern over the threat from the Islamic State (IS), and counterterrorism efforts have resulted in the arrest of numerous individuals and the foiling of various plots. Unrest occurs periodically over various socioeconomic and political issues. Protests are typically of a low level and peaceful but have the potential to escalate into violence.

Civil Unrest

● 2.50

Italy experiences frequent demonstrations and protests related to a wide array of issues. Rallies often involve Italian politics or Italian unions. Student groups such as the COBAS student union periodically organize rallies with large turnouts. Topics sparking unrest include anti-globalization, anti-capitalist, anti-austerity, feminist, and environmental issues. Immigration is a recent issue of concern, sparking demonstrations by both pro- and anti-migrant groups in Italy's major cities, including Rome, Milan, and Bologna. These rallies have the potential to escalate into violence. Illegal migrants held in detention centers may also riot, leading to an enhanced risk of localized violence. Protests can also involve journalists and members of the press campaigning against perceived targeting by the coalition government.

Italy has seen increasingly widespread and disruptive waves of pro-Palestinian activism through 2025. Labor unions, human rights organizations, and other civil society groups have led nationwide protests, port blockades, and general strikes denouncing Israeli activity in the Gaza Strip and calling on the government to impose sanctions on Tel Aviv. Protests have repeatedly turned violent, including in Bologna, Pisa, Milan, Rome, Venice, and Udine. Demonstrations have been widespread with mass participation across numerous Italian cities. Pro-Palestinian actions have ranged from 24-hour strikes and union-led protests to public amenity occupations. During periods of intense Israeli military activity, protesters blocked port areas in Genoa and Livorno, impeding the movement of goods. Demonstrations may also take place near venues hosting sporting and cultural events featuring Israeli teams.

Protesters usually congregate in public areas, outside government buildings, and at diplomatic missions. While most protests are peaceful, some have resulted in violence, including confrontations with the police. Radical elements periodically infiltrate anti-government demonstrations and clash with security forces. Most of these incidents occur in Rome. Protests do not typically directly target foreign nationals or assets.

Issues involving football (soccer) have a high tendency to erupt in violence due to the large numbers of "ultra" hardcore fans in the country. Violent clashes at football matches themselves are also not uncommon in Italy.

Labor strikes and work stoppages occur with some regularity, sometimes causing delays in transportation. Strikes and stoppages are usually well publicized in advance. Major labor unions Fiom and CGIL periodically stage strikes over socioeconomic issues that can affect local and regional public transportation as well as international flights, railroad networks, and ferry services.

Crime

● 2.50

Street crime, including petty theft, is a serious concern in large cities including Rome, Florence, and Naples. Most incidents occur in crowded tourist sites, on public busses or trains, or at major railway stations, such as Rome's Termini, Milan's Centrale, Florence's Santa Maria Novella, and Naples' Centrale. Thieves are opportunistic and known to target foreigners. Groups of petty street criminals may bump into travelers or spill something on them to divert their attention so that their accomplices can pickpocket them. Another scam involves criminals asking the victim for directions to distract them while another criminal takes a piece of luggage. Travel documents are a commonly reported stolen item.

Vehicle break-ins have been reported, particularly when vehicles are parked on the street. Criminals may target visible electronics, luggage, and other valuables. Thieves on scooters have been known to snatch bags from pedestrians, using razors to slash straps. Snatch-and-grab activities have targeted drivers waiting in traffic or stopped at traffic lights, particularly in Naples and the south. Abusive car attendants may extort small sums of money to safeguard parked vehicles, resorting to vandalism if the amount is not paid. There have been reports of thefts from yachts in the Gulf of Naples, and in the waters around Sorrento, Capri, and Positano.

Violent crime is rare, although there is a potential for violent escalation, particularly if a victim shows resistance. In Florence, where a large British and American community exists, there has been a reported increase of crimes against foreign female college students, including sexual assaults using date-rape drugs.

Organized crime in southern Italy is pervasive, having infiltrated the social and economic life of many places. Major groups include the Camorra, based in Naples and the Campania region, the 'Ndrangheta in Calabria, and the Cosa Nostra in Sicily. Organized criminal networks are extensively involved in extortion rackets, and businesses may be victimized if they do not pay protection money. Due to immigration, many foreign organized crime groups that come from Africa, Eastern Europe, and Asia have also started branching out in Italy. Organized crime groups are unlikely to directly affect tourists or business travelers.

Kidnapping

● 2.00

For most foreign nationals, the threat of kidnapping in Italy is low. Kidnappings are not a regular occurrence, and kidnappers are more likely to target locals. The most common types of abduction in Italy include basic opportunistic kidnap-for-ransom and high-net worth individual kidnap-for-ransom. Victims are usually released unharmed and relatively quickly.

Terrorism

● 2.00

Italy is a known operations and logistics base for Islamist militants in Europe. Hubs for such activity include Milan, Rome, and Naples, as well as several medium-sized cities in northern and southern parts of the country. There is particular concern over the threat from IS. Militants from IS have issued multiple threats against Italy in propaganda videos. Sunni extremist militants have specifically singled out the city of Rome, as well as Christian monuments and religious buildings in the country as potential targets. Other potential targets include tourist sites, monuments, transportation hubs, government buildings, water and electricity systems, US military bases, and Jewish religious buildings. Islamist terrorists are likely to use a range of weapons including bladed weapons, automatic rifles, explosives, and vehicles; however, Italy has not experienced any Islamist terrorist attacks in recent years.

Italy's porous coastal borders make it a point of first entry for migrants and asylum-seekers from North Africa, and there are concerns over militants infiltrating these groups. There are also concerns over the return of individuals who left the country to fight with IS abroad. Returning fighters will have increased proficiency in terms of carrying out an attack, and they are also likely to engage in radicalizing, fundraising, and facilitation activities. Italian authorities prioritize counterterrorism efforts, which have resulted in a number of arrests and foiled attacks.

Italy has a long history of combatting domestic terrorism. In the Cold War era, Italy frequently suffered from politically motivated terrorist attacks by far-right and far-left groups; however, most of the groups responsible for acts of political violence have since dissolved. With the recent populist wave across Europe, there is a possibility that political extremist groups could mobilize again. Likely targets for these groups include government buildings, public officials and some foreign corporations including banks. Most attacks by such groups are unsophisticated, involving homemade improvised explosive devices (IEDs) containing flammable liquids or gunpowder and crude ignition mechanisms, some of which fail to operate.

France authorities are enforcing heightened checks at their Schengen borders.

Armed Conflict

 1.00

There is no conflict threat to Italy at present.

Security Services

 2.00

Security forces in Italy are generally reliable. Responsiveness is good and overall security capabilities are robust. Police in major cities in Italy typically speak English, though this is less likely in more rural areas. Although Italy has a number of different security forces, the Polizia di Stato (State Police) and Carabinieri (military police) are likely to be the most relevant for foreign nationals and local staff.

Interaction with Travelers

In Italy, travelers in need of assistance should contact their diplomatic mission if possible, but may also rely on security forces.

Law Enforcement Reliability

The threat that security forces pose is generally low.

Infrastructure

 2.50 - Moderate

There are no significant concerns in Italy over air travel.

Roads and highways are of good quality and well maintained with extensive lighting, except for in more remote areas. However, there have been significant concerns over some of the country's infrastructure since the Morandi bridge tragedy in which 43 people died. The Morandi bridge collapsed due to problems with its design, construction, and maintenance. It was the fifth bridge collapse in five years in Italy.

Ports are relatively efficient and the ferry system is considered good.

Utilities are generally good.

There is growing concern over cyber attacks targeting government or business interests.

Ground Transport

 2.75

Roads and highways are of good quality and well maintained with extensive lighting, except for in more remote areas. Italy's road travel fatality rate remains low, compared to other countries in the region. City streets are often narrow, winding, and congested. Driving can be stressful as traffic laws are often not followed or enforced. Italian drivers may drive aggressively and at high rates of speed. Scooters have been known to use the sidewalks and median to get around vehicles at traffic lights. Italian motorists often fail to yield to pedestrians (despite being required by Italian law) and vehicle accidents involving pedestrians are common. In the north, fog and poor visibility cause accidents each year, especially in the winter.

Cars are not permitted in many historical centers, particularly in northern towns, where access is limited to bicycles and pedestrians. Some historical centers have restricted traffic zones that require a special permit to access. These zones may be marked as ZTL (*Zona Traffico Limitato*). Drivers who enter these zones without a permit may be fined.

Public transportation is readily available and reliable in all major Italian cities. While busses are the most common form of such transport, Milan and Rome are also equipped with subway systems. Bus tickets must be purchased in advance at a tobacco shop (*tabacchi*) and validated on the bus. Subway tickets can be purchased at the subway station. Service is generally good on all public transportation systems, although they can be crowded at peak hours. Petty criminals may operate on crowded busses and subway cars.

Taxis are available in most cities and usually wait at taxi stands located throughout the city.

Rail travel is of good quality. Daytime and overnight international services connect Italy with the main cities and towns in Austria, Germany, France, and Eastern Europe. Domestic rail services link to most Italian cities. Car and passenger ferries operate throughout the year linking Italian ports to each other along the mainland coast and those in Sardinia and Sicily. They also serve international destinations in Croatia, Greece, Spain, France, and Tunisia.

Local Buses

● Unrated

Intercity buses are available between most major cities. Intercity buses have a good safety record. Petty theft and other criminal activities pose a low threat to travelers.

City buses are available in most urban centers. City buses have a good safety record. Petty theft and other criminal activities pose a low threat to travelers.

Mass Transit

● Unrated

Metro systems are available in most major cities in Italy. The country's metro systems are generally efficient and safe. Derailments and other accidents are rare. Securing personal items onboard metro trains is important, as theft is a standard threat. Terrorism poses a minimal threat to metro networks. Terrorists have not attacked metro systems in Italy in the past decade. Terror warnings are rare on Italy's metro networks.

Taxis

● Unrated

Taxis are readily available in all major cities in Italy. Traffic accidents involving taxis are rare, and crime on taxis poses a moderate threat to travelers. Overcharging is commonly perpetrated against taxi passengers, especially foreign nationals. Taxis arranged in advance by upscale hotels or trusted business associates are generally safer than those hailed on the street.

Ride-sharing services or vehicles ordered through online apps are available in some major cities in Italy.

Train Travel

● Unrated

Train Safety

Trains in Italy have a good recent safety record. Derailments and rail accidents involving passenger trains rarely occur. Incidents of petty theft are rare on trains in Italy. Rail stations in Italy are generally safe. Petty crime poses a moderate threat at rail stations.

Reliability and Availability

Italy has an extensive intercity passenger rail network. Rail travel is available between all major cities and few smaller cities and towns. High-speed rail services are available between many major cities. Trains in Italy generally run on time.

International Rail Travel

Italy has international rail connections with multiple countries. Connections between Italy and countries are subject to border controls, and passengers may be required to pass through customs before crossing. France authorities are enforcing heightened checks at their Schengen borders.

Vehicles and Roads

● Unrated

Road safety conditions in Italy are generally good. Traffic in Italy drives on the right. Roads in cities are generally paved and well maintained. Drivers generally obey traffic laws. Police rigorously enforce traffic laws. Criminals sometimes steal from parked vehicles. Foreigners planning to drive in Italy must have an International Driving Permit (IDP). Car rentals are available in most major cities.

International Road Travel

Italy has international road connections with Slovenia, Austria, Switzerland, and France. Italy has relaxed border controls with EU member states. French authorities are enforcing heightened checks at their Schengen borders.

Cyber

● 3.00

Geostrategic Concerns

Italy's cybersecurity environment presents a medium level of risk, with good governance and resilience supported by its EU and NATO memberships. Authorities state that cyberattacks continue to increase annually, particularly on central and local public administration, telecommunications companies, healthcare providers, and energy suppliers. However, Italy's strong public-private coordination, and close integration with EU and NATO security frameworks mitigate much of this risk. Internet censorship and surveillance are low, reflecting strong protection of user rights and digital freedoms.

Italy's legal and regulatory environment is among the most advanced globally. It implements EU measures such as the GDPR and NIS2 Directive, which impose strict obligations on data protection, breach reporting, and resilience in critical sectors. The National Cyber Security Agency (ACN) provides coordination between government, defense, and operators of essential services. Regulatory enforcement is consistent and reliable.

Cybercrime

Cybercrime is prevalent in Italy. Officials report that Italy has the third highest level of cyber-crime such as ransomware in Europe. Other common threats include phishing and credential theft, with small and medium-sized enterprises facing greater vulnerability due to more limited cybersecurity resources. Multinational firms in defense, logistics, and energy may be indirectly exposed through supply chain compromise. Italian law enforcement is well-resourced and effective in prosecuting cybercrime, with close collaboration between government and private industry. Overall, Italy's resilient digital infrastructure reduces systemic risk.

Maritime Services

1.50

Italy and mostly its southern islands experience overwhelming migration flows. Despite regional and national efforts, the number of vessels carrying migrants is likely to disrupt maritime routes and operations in waters between Libya and Italy.

Air Travel

2.00

There are no significant concerns over air travel to and from Italy. Italy has more than 130 airports. Two major hubs for international travel are Rome's Leonardo Da Vinci International Airport (FCO) and Milan's Malpensa International Airport (MXP). Other cities with international airports include Florence, Genoa, Pisa, Naples, Palermo, Turin, Bologna, and Venice. Security and facilities are considered adequate at Italian airports.

Travelers should be aware that flights to Italy may be canceled or disrupted due to the ongoing coronavirus disease (COVID-19) pandemic. Although Italy reopened its borders to citizens from the EU, UK, Schengen Area, Andorra, and Monaco on 2021 June 3, flights may still not be operating on normal schedules. Flights to Italy from countries not mentioned above are likely to operate on significantly reduced schedules over the near term.

As a result of an EU ban in connection with Russia's invasion of Ukraine, Italian airspace is closed to all Russian aircraft and flights.

Utilities

2.00

Utilities infrastructure is generally considered dependable, and there are no major issues with electricity, gas, and water services.

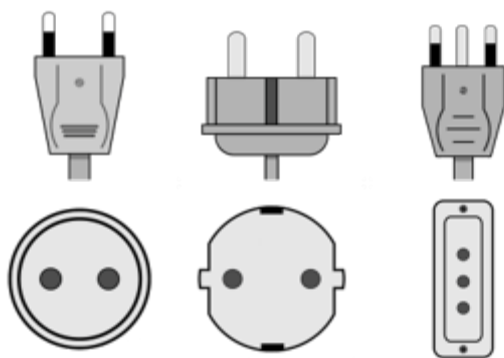
Internet services are developed, although they feature some of the slowest speeds in the EU.

Electricity

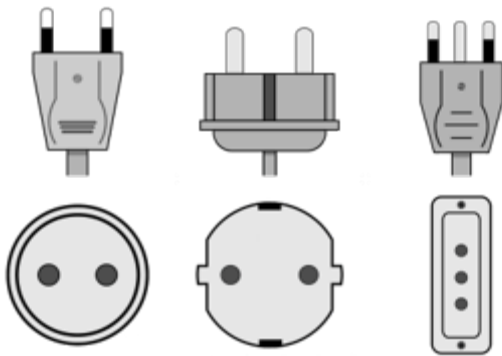
Unrated

Electricity in Italy is supplied at 230 V, 50 Hz. Italy uses Type C, F, and L plugs.

Plug Types



Types de prises



Internet and Telecommunications

● Unrated

Internet service in Italy is readily available in most public/private accommodations, and internet cafes. Internet activity is considered private and secure in most areas - see Information Security advice sheet.

Environment

2.00 - Low

The climate of Italy varies throughout the country, with a moderately continental climate across much of inland Italy, a Mediterranean climate in coastal and island regions, and a mountain climate in northern Alpine regions. Temperature and precipitation levels vary across the different climate regions; however, it is generally hot and humid during this summer and relatively cold during the winter. Heavy rainfall, associated flooding, and mudslides can occur throughout the year, often disrupting travel and essential services.

Earthquakes occur occasionally, particularly in the central and southern regions. Major quakes are relatively infrequent but can be deadly when they do occur. There are several volcanoes throughout the country, both active and dormant.

Man-Made Hazards

● 1.75

Italy was heavily mined during World War II, and while the remaining risk to travelers is small, unexploded ordnance is still sometimes found, prompting evacuations of the immediate area.

Seismic

● 3.00

Most of Italy lies on seismic fault lines, although only certain regions are at high risk for earthquakes, particularly the central and southern regions. Most earthquakes are moderate and cause limited damage and injuries. However, major quakes can be deadly, exacerbated in parts of the country by old and unstable infrastructure and poor building standards. Tremors can also trigger landslides and avalanches in Alpine and other mountainous regions.

As a result of its location in an active seismic region, Italy experiences frequent volcanic activity. There are 13 volcanoes in Italy, spread across three zones: the Gulf of Naples, the area northeast of Sicily, and near the Mediterranean island of Pantelleria. Three of these volcanoes remain active and are liable to erupt: Mount Vesuvius (famous for its destruction of the towns of Pompeii and Herculaneum in 79 AD) on the border of the Bay of Naples; Stromboli in the archipelago of the Aeolian Islands to the north of Sicily; and Etna, situated close to the city of Catania. Mount Etna and Stromboli are two of the world's most active volcanoes, and Mount Vesuvius is the only active volcano in mainland Europe.

Storm System

● 2.00

Heavy rainfall, associated flooding, and mudslides can occur throughout the year, often disrupting travel and essential services. Although autumn is generally the rainiest season, spring and summer storms can also produce sudden heavy downpours. Venice experiences *acqua alta* (high water) flooding late September-April, especially in the months of October, November, and December. Snowstorms can occur December-March, especially in elevated areas. Avalanches are a risk in mountainous regions, particularly the Alps.

Natural Hazards

2.00

Italy's coast experiences a Mediterranean climate with hot, dry summers and mild winters. In some parts of Sicily and Sardinia, the climate is like a desert or is subtropical. Extreme heat can be a risk in these areas during the summer, especially for the elderly. In the north, the Alps have a mountain climate, with cold, snowy winters and cool, rainy summers. Avalanches can pose a threat in Alpine regions. The lowlands of the Po Valley experience humid, hot summers and cold winters with frequent fog. Flooding can occur across much of Italy following persistent heavy rainfall during the autumn and winter or heavy downpours during spring and summer storms.

Both earthquakes and volcanoes pose a latent threat in Italy; although major seismic disasters are infrequent, the consequences of these can be severe when they do occur.

Air Quality

Unrated

Air Quality

Air pollution is considerably higher in urban areas, especially in Bologna, Brescia, Florence, Milan, Modena, Naples, Padua, Rome, and Turin. Individuals with asthma or chronic cardiorespiratory conditions should consult with a healthcare provider prior to travel and carry sufficient medications. On days when air quality is particularly poor, affected individuals should take personal precautions to reduce respiratory stress([map](#)).

Health and Medical

2.25 - Low

There are no major health-related concerns except for insect-borne diseases. Medical facilities are available throughout the country and are of good quality in major cities. Facilities may be limited outside urban areas. Pharmacies are generally well stocked. Tap water is safe to drink.

Disease and Health Threats

2.00

- **Altitude Sickness:** Some locations in Italy, including the Alps and the Dolomites, are above 2,440 meters (8,000 feet). Some people may experience adverse health effects at such altitudes. Ascend gradually to allow for acclimatization and remain watchful for signs of altitude sickness or more severe manifestations.
- **Dengue Fever:** Transmitted through the bite of an infected mosquito, mainly during the day. Bite prevention is essential. Symptoms of dengue fever include a sudden onset of fever and at least one of the following: severe headache, severe pain behind the eyes, muscle and/or joint pain, rash, easy bruising, and/or nose or gum bleeding. Fever and other symptoms generally appear abruptly four to seven days after being bitten. Some people have reported experiencing no symptoms. Locally acquired dengue fever cases have been reported in the Abruzzo, Emilia-Romagna, Lombardy, Lazio, Marche, Tuscany and Veneto regions. The risk of infection is highest from May to November.
- **Hepatitis A:** Transmitted by contaminated food and water. Hepatitis A does not always cause symptoms. If they occur, symptoms appear two to six weeks after exposure and include fever, nausea, vomiting, abdominal pain, fatigue, dark urine, loss of appetite, joint

pain, and jaundice. In Italy, hepatitis A is endemic, especially in the southern regions, where the practice of consuming raw seafood is more widespread. However, epidemics or sporadic cases may occur throughout the country, linked to consuming contaminated food (not only seafood but also vegetables and fruit) or water (e.g., well water), travel to endemic areas, or poor hygiene conditions. Very low risk in Italy.

- **Hepatitis B:** Transmitted through infected blood and bodily fluids and effectively prevented with vaccination. An unexpected medical or dental emergency may place the unvaccinated traveler at risk. Practice safe sex and ensure medical procedures, tattoos, or piercings are conducted using sterile equipment. Symptoms include fever, nausea, vomiting, abdominal pain, fatigue, dark urine, loss of appetite, joint pain, and jaundice. Low risk in Italy.
- **Hepatitis E:** Transmitted by contaminated food and water. Symptoms appear two to eight weeks after exposure and include fever, nausea, vomiting, abdominal pain, dark urine, joint pain, and jaundice.
- **HIV/AIDS:** Transmitted through infected blood and bodily fluids. Practice safe sex and ensure medical procedures, tattoos, or piercings are conducted using sterile equipment. Within two to four weeks of HIV infection, many people, but not all, experience influenza-like illness, including fever, swollen glands, sore throat, rash, fatigue, muscle and joint pains, and headache. These symptoms, also called acute retroviral syndrome (ARS), can last from days to weeks. Without treatment, the infection can lead to AIDS (Acquired Immune Deficiency Syndrome).
- **Leishmaniasis:** Transmitted through the bites of sandflies. Risk is greatest from dusk to dawn. Cutaneous leishmaniasis is the most common form of *Leishmania* infection, causing skin sores that are usually painless. Visceral leishmaniasis is the second most common; typical symptoms include high fever, substantial weight loss, swelling of the spleen and liver, and anemia. If left untreated, this form of leishmaniasis is nearly 100 percent fatal within two years. Both visceral and cutaneous leishmaniasis are endemic in Italy. Cutaneous leishmaniasis is endemic to Calabria, the Abruzzi region, Sicily, and the Adriatic side of the Apennines. Visceral leishmaniasis is most common in Sicily, Sardinia, Tuscany, and along the Adriatic Coast, with the highest rates in Sicily and the Naples region.
- **Leptospirosis:** Transmitted through exposure or ingestion of water contaminated with the urine of infected animals. Flooding poses an additional risk of contracting leptospirosis. Initial symptoms of leptospirosis typically develop two days to four weeks after exposure. Such symptoms include headache, fever, muscle aches, chills, diarrhea, vomiting, and abdominal pain. Those who may be at high risk can take an antibiotic prophylaxis. In Italy, leptospirosis rates peak during August. The risk of infection is highest in rural areas or for individuals involved in at-risk occupational or recreational activities.
- **Rabies:** Transmitted through the saliva of infected wild or domesticated mammals, usually by a bite or scratch. Do not approach unfamiliar animals. No Known risk.
- **Tick-borne Encephalitis (TBE):** Transmitted through the bite of an infected tick. Bite prevention is essential. In rare cases, people can become infected by consuming unpasteurized dairy products. Early symptoms include fever, fatigue, headache, myalgia, and nausea. These symptoms generally appear two to 10 days after exposure. In some cases, infection can progress to encephalitis (inflammation of the brain), which can be life-threatening. The risk of infection exists primarily in pre-alpine and alpine areas in the northeast, including Veneto (mainly Belluno alps), Friuli-Venezia Giulia, and Trentino-South Tyrol regions. Risk is highest from April to November, with the highest transmission recorded in July.
- **Traveler's Diarrhea:** Transmitted by contaminated food and water. This is the most common illness in travelers. People who become ill by an infectious agent that causes traveler's diarrhea most often experience nausea, vomiting, fever, bloody stools, and/or the urge to constantly pass stool despite an empty gastrointestinal tract. Low risk in Italy.
- **Tuberculosis:** Transmitted through respiratory droplets released by coughing or sneezing. Individuals planning an extended stay should consider obtaining a PPD skin test to reference against future suspected infections. Symptoms commonly include chest pain, a

bad cough lasting three weeks or longer, and coughing up blood and/or sputum. Some people also experience chills, weight loss, fever, weakness, night sweats, and loss of appetite. Intermediate risk in Italy.

- **West Nile Virus:** Transmitted through the bite of an infected mosquito, mostly between dusk and dawn. Bite prevention is essential. West Nile virus symptoms include fever, headache, body aches, joint pains, vomiting, diarrhea, and rash. Most people experience no symptoms. The risk of West Nile Virus is present throughout Italy, especially in the northern region. The risk of infection is typically highest from May to November.

Health Requirements

● Unrated

Yellow Fever: Vaccination Not Required

There are no recommendations or requirements for yellow fever vaccination in Italy. There is no risk of yellow fever.

HIV Testing

No known restrictions

Health Recommendations

● Unrated

Recommended Immunizations for Travel to Italy

Travelers should ensure that they have routine vaccination courses and boosters. You should visit a healthcare professional at least four to six weeks before the trip. Routine vaccines include measles-mumps-rubella (MMR), diphtheria-tetanus-pertussis, varicella (chickenpox), polio, and the annual flu vaccine. Travelers should consider obtaining COVID-19 vaccination where available, even if the destination country does not require it.

- **Hepatitis A:** Recommended for most individuals unless contraindicated. Two doses, administered at least six months apart, are required for long-lasting protection. It is recommended that all susceptible people traveling for any purpose, frequency, or duration to countries with high or intermediate hepatitis A endemicity be vaccinated or receive immune globulin before departure. A booster is recommended for partially vaccinated travelers.
- **Hepatitis B:** Recommended for most individuals unless contraindicated. Widely used formulations require three doses administered over the course of six to 18 months, depending on the recipient's age and vaccination history. Booster doses after a complete series are usually not required to maintain immunity. If exposed before finalizing the full series, individuals may receive a special booster within 24 hours for short-term protection.
- **Rabies:** Unless contraindicated, the WHO and CDC recommend vaccination for individuals who will be performing occupational or recreational activities that increase the risk for exposure to potentially rabid animals, such as animal handlers, field biologists, cavers, missionaries, veterinarians, and some laboratory workers. It is also recommended for travelers who might have difficulty getting prompt access to safe post-exposure prophylaxis. Italy has not reported any rabies cases, thus most travelers are at low risk. Bats are likely to carry bat rabies.
- **Tick-borne Encephalitis:** Recommended for individuals trekking, working, or engaging in outdoor activities in high-risk, endemic areas, particularly heavily forested areas where the disease occurs and ticks are likely to be found. Currently, a tick-borne encephalitis vaccine is available in many countries. The initial vaccine consists of three doses and requires six months or more for completion. Tick bite prevention is also essential.

Medical Facilities and Services

 2.50

Medical facilities are available throughout the country and are of good quality in major cities. Facilities may be limited outside urban areas. Private clinics and hospitals usually offer better services than public facilities. Hospitals and doctors usually require advance payment or proof of adequate insurance before admitting a patient. A European Health Insurance Card (EHIC) allows access to state-provided healthcare at a reduced cost or sometimes for free. Ambulance services are readily available.

Medications and Pharmacy

 Unrated

Pharmacies across Italy are readily available, but availability may vary by region. Supply of most medicines needed by travelers is high. Prior to travelling confirm the status of your "over the counter" medicines with accredited foreign government offices of Italy in your country. Always carry your prescription medication in its original packaging, along with your doctor's prescription and any other relevant documentation.

Mental Health

 3.00

Mental health service availability is limited and conditions are moderately managed.

Food and Water Safety

 2.00

Drinking water is generally safe in Italy. However, officials still recommend drinking bottled or otherwise purified water whenever possible to reduce the risk of traveler's diarrhea or other gastrointestinal illnesses. Ensure that food is properly handled and prepared. Wash raw produce before eating. Consume only pasteurized milk and dairy products, or use powdered or canned milk and cured cheeses. Consider avoiding street vendors and unregulated food establishments.

Political

 2.25 - Low

Italy is a multi-party parliamentary representative democratic republic. The Prime Minister is the head of government, while the President serves as the head of state. The prime minister and the cabinet together exercise executive power, while legislative power resides with a bicameral parliament consisting of the Chamber of Deputies and the Senate. The judiciary is independent of the executive and the legislature. General elections take place at least once every five years, though elections may take place earlier in the event of government collapse.

Coalitions featuring a cross-section of political parties are typically required to form the government. Despite regular government collapses, state institutions are mostly competent and effective, and provide reliable services across most of the country.

Corruption

 2.75

The perception of corruption in Italy is moderate.

Although corruption is not a major obstacle to conducting business in Italy, it has been a matter of concern. Corruption seems to have decreased in recent years and paying a bribe has become rarer. However, clientelism and nepotism are prevalent in the public administration and the business environment. Public and private actors maintain close relationships. The misappropriation of public funds by the mafia in some regions, most notably in Sicily, contributes to maintaining an increased perception of corruption. Public trust in the judiciary is low. Politicians accused of corruption are rarely dismissed. Anti-corruption legislation remains weak or poorly implemented.

Government Stability

 2.25

Italy is a multiparty democracy featuring free and fair elections. Transfers of power are smooth and peaceful, and the government is typically formed by a coalition of political parties representing a cross-section of political opinions. Ruling coalitions almost always depend on the support of minority parties. Divisions between coalition partners regularly lead to government collapse and/or early elections being called.

Civil liberties are broadly respected both in law and in practice. Corruption is an ongoing problem. Governments are generally perceived to craft and enact policy ineffectively to moderately effectively, and the judiciary is generally fair and efficient.

The primary institutional issues in Italy are government ineffectiveness and corruption. The Italian government has thus far failed to deal effectively with asymmetrical economic development, leading to starkly contrasting business and social realities between the North and South. Italian politics is increasingly divided, and public frustration with a perceived lack of progress in economic development and anti-corruption efforts has fueled the rise of populist politics. Italian citizens generally report higher perceived levels of corruption and lower levels of government trust than citizens of most other EU member states.

Rule of Law

 2.00

The judiciary may come under pressure from the government. The legal system can be inefficient, taking years for a case to come to court. Businesses have relatively low confidence in the Italian legal system.

Low-level corruption exists within the police, who have been known to periodically solicit bribes or facilitation payments. Law enforcement in the country is mainly provided by the Polizia di Stato (civil national police) and the Carabinieri (military police), and they carry out many of the same law enforcement and investigative duties. Both the Polizia di Stato and the Carabinieri are well equipped, well trained, and generally very efficient. Response time is also generally good. Many police, especially outside of major cities, do not speak English.

Sanctions

 2.00

There are no sanctions currently facing Italy by EU, US, or UN mandates. A Russian embargo (in retaliation for the EU and US's sanctions regarding the situation in Ukraine) on agricultural products from the EU is in place and has affected some parts of the Italian economy.

Legal

Unrated

Visitors to Italy are subject to local laws, which may not mirror, either in whole or in part, those of their home country. Those deemed to be in violation, even unknowingly, may be fined, detained, imprisoned, temporarily or permanently expelled, or tried *in absentia* depending on the nature of the offense. Home-country consular officers are typically systematically informed of a detention and permitted to provide support services to their detained citizens. When there is no treaty in force, notification and access depend on whether the two countries have direct or indirect diplomatic relations. Consular officers cannot interfere with local judicial proceedings, nor provide legal advice or representation at trial, and are unable to pay legal fees or fines with government funds. The status of dual nationals will be determined by local officials, with all attendant ramifications for access and support.

Emergency Contacts

 Unrated

Emergency Contacts

Ambulance 112 / 118

Fire 112 /115

Police 112/ 113

Embassies and Consulates

● Unrated

Austrian Embassy

Address Via G. Pergolesi 3, 00198 Rome
Telephone Number +39 06 844 0141
Email rom-ob@bmeia.gv.at
Web Site <https://www.bmeia.gv.at/it/ambasciata-daustria-a-roma>

US Consulate

Address Piazza della Repubblica, 80122 Napoli
Numéro de téléphone +39 081 583 8111
Email uscitizensnaples@state.gov
Web Site <https://it.usembassy.gov/embassy-consulates/naples/>
Opening Hours Monday to Friday: 0830-1230

British Consulate-General

Address Via San Paolo 7, I-20121 Milan
Telephone Number +39 02 723001
Email Milan.Consular@fco.gov.uk
Web Site <https://www.gov.uk/world/organisations/british-consulate-general-milan>
Opening Hours Monday to Friday: 08:30-17:30

German Embassy

Address Via San Martino della Battaglia 4, 00185 Roma.
Telephone Number +39 06 492131
Email info@rom.diplo.de
Web Site <https://italien.diplo.de/it-de/vertretungen/deutsche-botschaft-rom>
Opening Hours Monday - Thursday 9 a.m. - 12 p.m. and 2.30 p.m. - 4.00 p.m. Friday 9 a.m. - 1 p.m.

Australian Embassy

Address Via Antonio Bosio 5, 00161, Rome
Telephone Number +39 06 852 721
Email info-rome@dfat.gov.au; consular-rome@dfat.gov.au
Web Site <https://italy.embassy.gov.au/rome/home.html>
Opening Hours Monday to Friday: 0900-1700

Canadian Embassy

Address Via Zara, 30 00198, Rome

Telephone Number +39 06 854441

Email consul.rome@international.gc.ca

Web Site <https://www.international.gc.ca/country-pays/italy-italie/rome.aspx?lang=eng>

Opening Hours Monday to Friday: 0900-1200

US Consulate

Address Lungarno Vespucci 38, 50123 Firenze

Telephone Number +39 055 266951

Email uscitizensflorence@state.gov

Web Site <https://it.usembassy.gov/embassy-consulates/florence/>

Opening Hours Monday to Friday: 0830-1230

British Embassy

Address Via XX Settembre 80, I-00187 Roma RM

Telephone Number +39 06 4220 0001

Email ukinitaly@fcdo.gov.uk

Web Site <https://www.gov.uk/world/organisations/british-embassy-rome>

Opening Hours Monday - Friday, 9.00am - 5.00pm

French Embassy

Address Piazza Farnese 67, 00186 Rome

Telephone Number +39 06 686011

Email consulat-rome@france-italia.it

Web Site <https://it.ambafrance.org/>

Opening Hours Monday to Friday: 0900-1900 Saturday: 0900-1700

US Consulate

Address Via Principe Amedeo 2/10, 20121 Milano

Telephone Number +39 02 290351

Email uscitizensmilan@state.gov

Web Site <https://it.usembassy.gov/embassy-consulates/milan/>

Opening Hours Monday to Friday: 0830-1700

US Embassy

Address Via Vittorio Veneto 121, 00187 Roma

Telephone Number +39 06 46741

Email uscitizensrome@state.gov

Web Site <https://it.usembassy.gov/embassy-consulates/rome/>

Opening Hours Monday to Friday: 0830-1230

Entry/Exit

Unrated

Travelers can obtain specific information about visas and other entry-exit requirements at: <https://entry-exit.crisis24horizon.com/>.

Pre-Departure

Unrated

- Travelers should provide friends and family a copy of travel itinerary and make a copy of important travel and identification documents.
- Travelers should have adequate travel insurance in place to enable rapid medical treatment or emergency extraction from country.

On Arrival

Unrated

- There are no significant measures to undertake when arriving in country.

In Transit

Unrated

- Public transport is generally safe, and self-driving may be conducted.

At Your Hotel

Unrated

- There are no extraneous measures that should be undertaken at the hotel.

In the Street

Unrated

- Petty crime represents the primary concern and travelers may be targeted by opportunistic theft. Travelers should avoid overt displays of wealth and dress discreetly and appropriately to environment. Do not display money, jewelry, or valuables and keep a low profile.
- Travelers should settle small bills with cash and have a spare credit card available. Travelers should use only small denominations of the local currency and keep large amounts of cash and cards in a separate place on your person. Reduce the contents of your wallet or bag contents, particularly cards which may denote affiliations, memberships, and accounts.
- Travelers should ensure that they carry their mobile phone with them at all times and that it has sufficient battery life and is programmed with appropriate emergency numbers. Travelers should also carry an ID card or passport, and any emergency medical information.
- Travelers should be aware of their location and surroundings. Avoid high-crime areas and do not travel by foot through isolated, urban areas after dark, particularly if traveling alone. Travelers should know routes and carry a map if necessary, but keep it concealed.
- In crowded situations and tourist locations, travelers should be aware of jostling as this may be a ploy for pickpockets. Travelers should also be aware of people loitering and attackers who may first pass their victim to attack from behind.
- Travelers should ignore verbal 'bait' from passers-by; do not get into an argument and avoid eye contact with strangers. Women traveling in Italy should remain vigilant in bars and nightclubs; avoid leaving drinks unattended, as they may be spiked.
- Travelers should note that illegal traders operate on the streets of all major Italian cities, particularly tourist cities like Florence, Venice, and Rome. Those buying from such traders may be stopped by the local police and fined.

- Same-sex sexual activity is legal and accepted in major cities; however, many Italians are conservative and isolated incidents of LGBT+ discrimination are occasionally reported. Overt displays of affection by LGBT+ couples can attract a negative response, especially in smaller towns.
- Travelers should be aware that photographing government buildings or military facilities may result in detention by authorities. Travelers should ask permission before taking pictures of locals, especially women.
- Demonstrations and protests occur periodically. Travelers should avoid demonstrations, protests, and rallies, which may attract security forces and law enforcement officers and present a dynamic and volatile environment. Travelers should also be advised that such incidents may disrupt local transport networks.

Culture

Unrated

Standard Hours of Operation

Business: Monday-Friday, 0900-1700 (North) 0800-1900 (South)

Government: Monday-Friday, 0900-1700

Banking: Monday-Friday, 0830-1330 and 1500-1600

Business attire is generally semi-formal.

Appointments are best scheduled Monday-Friday between 1000 and 1500. Arriving on time to meetings or social engagements is a common practice. Informal or personal discussions are common. Scheduled meetings will typically run longer than expected. If a meeting includes dining out, the host offers to pay the check. Alcohol taken during lunch and dinner is considered normal.

Italian and English are commonly used for business purposes. Attempts by visitors to use phrases in the native language are well received, and are expected. Business cards are widely used. Always use Mr./Ms. or a local honorific/title until the host indicates that using first names is appropriate. Addressing the host according to their official title is seen as a sign of respect. Shake hands when beginning and departing a business meeting.

Gestures

Unrated

Business cards are widely used; when in use, they are presented with the reverse side printed in Italian.

When beginning the meeting, shake hands with everyone using the right hand. Always greet elderly people and women first. When departing the meeting, shake hands again.

Avoid using the following gestures or habits, as they are deemed offensive or insulting:

- Pointing with the index and little finger
- Slapping one's raised arm above the elbow
- Summoning someone with the hand, palm turned up
- Arrogance
- Chewing gum, slouching, or leaning in public

Religions

Unrated

Christian 81% (overwhelmingly Roman Catholic with very small groups of Jehovah's Witnesses and Protestants), Muslim 5%, unaffiliated 13%, other 1%

Ethnicities

● Unrated

Italian (includes small clusters of German-, French-, and Slovene-Italians in the north and Albanian-Italians and Greek-Italians in the south)

Significant Dates

● Unrated

2025 Significant dates

Jan. 1	New Year's Day
Jan. 6	Epiphany
April 21	Easter Monday
April 25	Liberation Day
May 1	Labor Day
June 2	Republic Day (National Day)
Aug. 15	Assumption of Mary
Nov. 1	All Saints' Day
Dec. 8	Immaculate Conception Day
Dec. 25-26	Christmas

Financial

Unrated

Financial systems can differ considerably by jurisdiction. Acceptance of cash, debit, and credit cards also varies across the country. Some locations may only accept cash due to the absence of card-processing machines. Banks or legal money changers typically offer the official exchange rates. While the import and export of both local and foreign currency are authorized, sums should not exceed the amount declared upon arrival.

Currency

● Unrated

Currency Name/Code

The official currency of Italy is the euro (EUR). One euro is made up of 100 cents.

Currency Convertibility

Banks or legal money changers offer the best exchange rates in Italy. Larger banks may offer the best exchange rates on average. Italy forbids foreigners from exiting with undeclared currency in amounts greater than EUR 10,000.

Credit Card

● Unrated

Major credit cards are widely accepted in shops, restaurants, and hotels.

Taxes and Tipping

● Unrated

It is not customary to tip hotel personnel, wait staff in restaurants, or taxi drivers; there may be a service charge on the bill.

Bank and ATM

● Unrated

ATMs

Automated teller machines are widely available in Italy. Always choose a machine located in a secure area, preferably within hotels or other populated, well-lit locations.

Bank Availability

Banking hours are generally Monday through Friday 0830-1330 and 1500-1600. Cash advances on major credit cards issued by foreign banks are permitted.

Active Alerts

No Alerts

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